



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Classical Consortium Academy
School Website: <https://www.classicalconsortiumacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Classical Consortium Academy (CCA) in Illinois demonstrates strong alignment with the core tenets of classical Christian education as defined by the six essential elements rubric. Public-facing materials show explicit commitments to a Christian worldview, formation of virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. The curriculum centers on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and, in upper levels, exposes students to the Quadrivium and Great Books through Omnibus-style courses. Pedagogy combines contemplative, memory-based practices (circle time, memory work, liturgical rhythm) with Socratic discussion and rhetoric in the upper grades. The faculty are presented as virtuous, mentoring teachers who form the living curriculum, and parents are positioned as partners in the education process. The school operates on a hybrid model across two campuses (Barrington and Glenview), with a strong emphasis on community, liturgy, and theological formation.

Overall classification by category: CLASSICAL in all six categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community). This assessment draws on explicit statements of faith, formation-focused aims, the integrated classical curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin; Omnibus/Great-Books approach), Socratic and memory-based pedagogy, a culture of virtuous living modeled by faculty, and active partnership with families.

- Evidence for the overall CLASSICAL classification is drawn from the school's Vision & Values, Distinctives, and Academics materials, including explicit statements about Truth/God/Beauty, formation and virtue, Great Books/Omnibus across grades, and a teacher-led living curriculum. Examples include: "God is at the center of all learning and our ultimate source of Truth... see the Good, the True, and the Beautiful" and the own-faith commitments in the Statement of Faith; a two-campus setting with a structured four-level trivium progression; Omnibus History/Literature and Latin offerings; and explicit mention of Socratic discussion and rhetoric in upper grades.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school places God at the center of all learning and frames Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as guiding ideals. - A formal Statement of Faith anchors epistemology and moral order in Scripture, underscoring a Christian worldview across disciplines. - The Vision emphasizes forming students' loves for the Good/True/Beautiful and the integration of faith into learning. - Worship and liturgical rhythm appear as a communal expression of learning (e.g., Worship Team, chapel-related references in Distinctives).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy/worship, sacred scripture, divine, Lord, faith, creed, wisdom, virtue, reverence, worship, sacred, Logos, moral formation, didactic unity of faith and reason.

- Negative keywords observed: none of the standard negative indicators (e.g., secular relativism, value-neutral ethics) appear in the public-facing materials.

Why this rating - The materials show a coherent theological foundation, explicit transcendental aims (truth/goodness/beauty), and liturgical/community practices, aligning strongly with Classical/Scholastic metaphysical grounding. The presence of a formal Statement of Faith and explicit faith-centered mission supports a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and the love of learning, rather than solely job preparation. The Vision states formation of love for wisdom and character, and the goal includes faithful living and learning. - The school frames education as formation and the development of human excellence, with transcendental aims (truth/goodness/beauty). - The Great-Books/Omnibus orientation anchors purpose in the cultivation of virtue, intellect, and moral imagination through integrated study.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, contemplation, the true/good/beautiful, classical education, great conversation, character, moral imagination, love of learning.

- Negative keywords observed: none indicating an emphasis on job-preparation at the expense of formation; the public materials emphasize formation over information.

Why this rating - The school explicitly prioritizes formation and virtue, with a teleological view of education in the classical sense (maintenance of the transcendentals and formation of character). This aligns with CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is organized around the traditional liberal arts trajectory (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and includes Latin study as core. The Grammar/Lexicon references Latin study as foundational and a core of classical education. - Omnibus History and Omnibus Literature & Composition integrate history, literature, theology, philosophy, and arts in a unified approach. - The Quadrivium is explicitly referenced at the upper levels, indicating an advanced, holistic mathematical/scientific framework beyond basic literacy. - Great Books/Great Conversation and the Great-Books oriented Omnibus approach (American Studies/Ancient-Modern rotations) are part of upper-level offerings. - Latin is viewed as central to classical education, with continuing study (Latin I/II) and foreign-language progression.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; trivium), Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), Great Books/Great Conversation, Omnibus, Latin, history integrated with theology, interdisciplinary/harmonic curriculum, wonder.

- Negative keywords observed: none indicating a deviation toward purely social-studies wording or a downgrading of Great Books; the site emphasizes liberal-arts integration.

Why this rating - The program explicitly centers on the grammar-logic-rhetoric sequence and includes Latin, Omnibus/Great-Books, and historical-literary integration with theological grounding, matching CLASSICAL expectations for Curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - A blend of contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) and rigorous inquiry is described; lower grades emphasize singing, memorization, and circle-time prayer, while upper grades engage in Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric.

- The pedagogy explicitly includes Socratic dialogue/seminars in higher levels; rhetoric training and public speaking are part of the upper grades (Rhetoric Level) with opportunities for speeches and theses. - The program emphasizes memorization, chreia, progymnasmata (early rhetorical exercises), and Latin chants as a memory/discipline foundation. - The Omnibus/Integrated approach creates cross-disciplinary discussions, primary texts, and the “great conversation” around foundational texts.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, seminars, debates, rhetoric, memorization/recitation, chanting, scholé, contemplative learning, liturgical rhythm, master-teacher modeling, living curriculum, circles/prayer, “great conversation,” and integration of faith with study.

- Negative keywords observed: none of the documented material shows a predominant reliance on purely project-based or constructivist-only pedagogy; rather, there is a balanced mix with direct memory work and Socratic inquiry. The public materials do not emphasize a solitary, purely student-directed approach.

Why this rating - The school employs a classical pedagogy that harmonizes contemplative/restful learning with rigorous analytical discussion and public-speaking training. The explicit presence of the trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic seminars, and memorization-based instruction supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty are described as model teachers who mentor and form the living curriculum; they are presented as a core, collaborative community of educators who uphold virtue and subject-matter mastery. - The “Our Team” page emphasizes dedicated Christian teachers and a collaborative, purpose-driven staff, aligning with the classical ideal of teachers as moral exemplars and living textbooks. - The school’s stated goals include mentorship, virtue, and character formation as central to pedagogy, with faculty benefits and profile statements reflecting these aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of teacher, masterful/mentoring educators, character formation, virtue, moral exemplars, faculty as the core of the school, collegiality among teachers. - Negative keywords observed: none indicating a departure from the classical teacher-leader model.

Why this rating - The materials consistently portray faculty as virtuous models, mentors, and central to the school’s pedagogy, aligning strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly positions parents as co-educators and partners, including opportunities for parental involvement, book groups, and community engagement; there are structures like a House System and family-centered activities. - The Distinctives emphasize partnering with families, fostering a learning community that includes parental formation and home-school collaboration. - Admission steps, informational meetings, and parent-focused resources (handbook, podcasts, parent gatherings) indicate an ongoing commitment to parent engagement and transparency.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, family involvement, home-school collaboration, parent meetings, open campus/visits (where applicable), communities of learners, parent engagement, and parental leadership references. - Negative keywords observed: minimal to none; the school does not present parents as customers but as co-educators, though one page notes a non-volunteer expectation for some roles; overall, parental involvement is framed positively.

Why this rating - The school’s public materials clearly present a collaborative model with families, multiple channels for parental involvement and formation, and a community-centric ethos consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Assessment - All six categories are CLASSICAL based on the keyword presence, textual evidence, and alignment with the Six Essential Elements framework. The school demonstrates a coherent classical Christian identity, a Trivium-based curriculum with Omnibus/Great Books, Socratic and rhetorical pedagogy, virtuous faculty, and active parental partnership.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable, as the school is assessed as CLASSICAL across all six categories. If future refinements were considered, they might focus on explicit documentation of Scholé rhythms and contemplative practices across more grade levels, or broader explicit articulation of Great Books in a standardized public-facing

curriculum map. However, these are optional improvements rather than required needle-moving changes for CLASSICAL status.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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